Chapter 1: Colonial Rule & The Indian Freedom Movement (Revolt of 185

Class 8 - Social Science | Unit: Our Pasts - III (History)

CHAPTER OVERVIEW & CORE FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS

Chronicles the commercial expansion of the British East India Company, colonial economic exploitation, and the nationwide uprising of 1857.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Analyze how the East India Company transitioned from trading enterprise to political ruling power.
2. Examine the multi-dimensional causes of the Revolt of 1857: political annexations (Doctrine of Lapse), economic ruin of artisans, and religious grievances.
3. Understand the aftermath: termination of Company rule and transfer of power to the British Crown in 1858.

1. CAUSES OF THE 1857 UPRISING

The uprising arose from widespread unrest: the Doctrine of Lapse annexed states like Jhansi and Satara; excessive land revenue ruined peasants; sepoys faced discriminatory pay and greased cartridge ammunition insulting religious beliefs.

2. POST-1857 ADMINISTRATIVE STRUCTURAL CHANGES

The Government of India Act 1858 placed India under direct authority of the British Crown represented by the Viceroy and Secretary of State for India, ending the East India Company monopoly.

DIAGNOSTIC FOCUS & COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students often identify the greased cartridges as the sole cause of 1857, ignoring deep-rooted economic disaffection, peasant displacement, and political annexation policies.

PREREQUISITE REINFORCEMENT QUESTIONS

Q1: Name two significant consequences of the Revolt of 1857 on British governance in India.

Expected Answer: 1. Rule of the East India Company ended and direct sovereignty was assumed by the British Crown. 2. The Governor-General was designated Viceroy of India.

Q2: What was Lord Dalhousie Doctrine of Lapse and how did it create resentment?

Expected Answer: It decreed that any princely state without a natural male heir would be annexed by the British, depriving adopted heirs of succession in states like Jhansi and Satara.